China, Russia, and India. Russian leaders believe that the West seeks to marginalize or isolate Moscow, if not to engage in actual regime change. Their common aversions extend to the imposition of any policy orthodoxy embodied in IMF conditionality, most frequently targeted at developing countries. The collective resistance to financial sanctions against Russia demonstrates the high premium that these leaders put on their countries' economic and political autonomy. Such protective reactions become even stronger, in that these threats are seen by the BRICS members as based on double standards and abuse of power by the incumbent powers and advanced economies. The three democracies also have experienced Western pressure and insensitivity. Moreover, both Brazil and South Africa have been actively involved in helping to negotiate settlements between warring or angry neighbors, and they value the alternative of quiet, nonthreatening diplomacy for dealing with incumbent governments of countries seen to have violated international norms.

Proposition 3. Collective financial statecraft among the BRICS countries is more likely when such cooperation promises to provide benefits, or "carrots," that each BRICS government can distribute in its own geographic region, increasing its regional status commensurately.

BRICS collaboration signals "carrots" and a strong commitment to cooperation with rising, non-Western, and/or Southern powers reaching beyond each member's geographic region. The four larger BRICS emphasize their commitment to provide financial resources and support (mostly counting on China's contributions) to all the emerging and developing regions. China has long aspired to be the champion of the developing world, and it has unrivaled contemporary links of investment and trade among developing and emerging regions worldwide—with or without the other BRICS. Russia, whose unilateral financial statecraft has always underscored its regional ambitions in Eurasia, hopes for opportunities to widen its scope and global reach through BRICS and gain Chinese economic support, but fears Chinese dominance. Both India and Brazil have provided significant aid and technical cooperation in sub-Saharan Africa, particularly in Anglophone and Lusophone countries, respectively, especially since the turn of the new century. Only for South Africa, however, is the opportunity to employ its BRICS membership to distribute benefits to its own geographic region a very significant motivation for political and financial collaboration within the club. Both